Town of Hilton Head Island
TOWN COUNCIL MEETING
Tuesday, August 11, 2026, 3:00 PM
Minutes

Call to Order

Mayor Perry called the meeting to order at 3:00 p.m.

Council Members present: Alan Perry, Mayor; Alex Brown, Ward 1, Mayor Pro-Tempore; Patsy Brison, Ward 2; Steve DeSimone, Ward 3; Tammy Becker, Ward 4; Steve Alfred, Ward 5; Melinda Tunner, Ward 6

Others Present: Marc Orlando, Town Manager; Brittany Ward, Town Attorney; Kim Gammon, Town Clerk

Pledge to the Flag

Invocation – Pastor Dorth, Island Lutheran Church

Pastor Dorth of Island Lutheran Church, delivered the invocation.

Adoption of the Agenda

Mr. Alfred moved to approve. Ms. Becker seconded. Motion carried 7-0.

Approval of the Minutes

Special Meeting Minutes of July 9, 2026

Mr. Alfred moved to approve. Ms. Becker seconded. Motion carried 7-0.

Regular Meeting Minutes of July 14, 2026

Mr. Alfred moved to approve. Ms. Becker seconded. Motion carried 7-0.

Presentations and Recognitions

Report of the Town Manager

Mr. Orlando provided updates on major capital projects including continued construction at Northpoint on Jarvis Creek and noted that a dedicated website is available for project updates and provided an update on the upcoming Land Management Ordinance Task Force meeting which will focus on natural resource protection provisions on wetlands and trees on the Jonesville Road and Bradley Circle areas as well as some revisions to subdivision and

residential development standards, with such provisions advancing to the Gullah Geechee Task Force, then to the Planning Commission and finally to Town Council. Mr. Orlando updated Council with progress at Mitchellville Freedom Park, improvements at Indigo Run, stormwater maintenance at Lake Liggett at Jarvis Creek Park, and the scheduled closure and renovation of Islanders Beach Park. He introduced the new Communications and Marketing Director, Kelly Spinella, and highlighted ongoing work with the Gullah Geechee CDC. He reviewed significant public safety investments, noting expanded technology, code enforcement presence, and coordination with the Beaufort County Sheriff's Office (BCSO). He outlined several Town Council requested actions including evaluation of a juvenile curfew ordinance, discontinuation of a public gathering ordinance, implementation of nighttime armed security patrols at beach parks, and continued enhancements to Coligny Beach Park based on a BCSO safety assessment. He stated that residents are encouraged to use the Everbridge app for real-time safety information and relayed that a comprehensive public safety framework will be presented in September to include cost-modeling, current service levels and partnership assessments with the BCSO. The Town Manager emphasized that public safety has been a sustained priority and that substantial actions, staffing, and investments have already been completed.

Town Council requested clarification on evening patrol hours at Hilton Head Island parks and facilities (from 7:00 p.m to 3:00 a.m.), and confirmation that certain parks that do not have parking gates would be included.

Recognition of Outgoing Town Attorney, Curtis Coltrane - Mayor Alan Perry

Curtis Coltrane was present to accept the commendation honoring him for twenty-one years of distinguished service as the Town Attorney of the Town of Hilton Head Island, with gratitude given on behalf of the Town of Hilton Head Island for Mr. Coltrane's lasting contributions made to the community.

USCB Sand Shark Welcome Week Proclamation - Mayor Alan Perry

Moriah Johnson, a Sophomore Nursing Major and Vice President of the USCB Student Government Association, was present to accept the proclamation recognizing USCB Sand Shark Welcome Week, on behalf of the University of South Carolina Beaufort.

Public Comment - Non-Agenda Items (Limited to 30 Minutes)

Terry Finger addressed Council to commend Curtis Coltrane and to praise him for his valuable skills and traits, especially his professionalism, as well as to thank Curtis for all of his years of service.

Richard Bisi addressed Council regarding public safety discussions and sponsorship of the Hilton Head Island Jam Songwriter Festival by the Town.

David Gorka addressed Council to inform them and to seek advice as to what property owners could do to dispute a proposed flood mitigation plan of the Palmetto Dunes Property Owners Association which includes the installation of a diesel pump on an easement between

two properties and to pump water underneath a third home within that community, and expressed concerns about the plan regarding noise, the possibility of creating storm trees as a result of the boring of a hole/holes underneath the tree canopy, the storing of diesel fuel for the diesel pump near a freshwater lake and the possibility of human error in connection with turning the pump on and off when needed, and suggested that there are alternative solutions which are gravity-based, not subject to human error and involve the repair of an existing system for the freshwater lake drainage.

Skip Hoagland addressed Council regarding the Town's budget, the Destination Marketing Organization Contract, funding of dredging in Harbor Town, sponsorship of the RBC Heritage golf tournament, sponsorship of the Hilton Head Island Jam Songwriter Festival, Town Council Executive Session meetings and mayoral candidates.

Dave Ferguson addressed Council regarding spending of tax dollars, questioned decision-making regarding such spending especially with regard to the Hilton Head Island Jam Songwriter Festival, and expressed concern over public trust.

Chester Williams addressed Council to express his appreciation for Curtis Coltrane, whose intention to always do the right thing and to treat people fairly, has made Mr. Williams' job so much easier over the years.

William Bosely addressed Council, as the Chairperson of Protect the Otter Creek and Indigo Run Rookery Committee, to speak for the protection and preservation of the Indigo Run Rookery, which is home to hundreds of birds who nest and birth their chicks in the Rookery, including protected species listed on the South Carolina and Federal protected bird lists. Mr. Bosely feels that the Rookery is in danger as a result of development of adjacent land across the creek and is asking Council to please help to protect the Rookery by enforcing all the Land Management Ordinance regulations that apply to the property being developed.

Sheila Broadbent addressed Council, as a member of Protect the Otter Creek and Indigo Run Rookery Committee, to inform Council that the Rookery is in danger as a result of development of adjacent land at 229 Marshland Road which includes the development of an 11.3 acre hard scape and the clear-cutting of trees which could result in flooding and erosion of the Otter Creek Watershed and asks for Council's help and guidance in protecting this sensitive environmental site.

Tom Charbonneau addressed Council, as a member of Protect the Otter Creek and Indigo Run Rookery Committee, to request Council's assistance in preventing the development at 229 Marshland Road from proceeding because their committee believes the development will cause irreparable environmental harm, threaten the survival of the Rookery and diminish the character and property values of the well-established low density residential neighborhoods in the area; additionally, he believes the development may be in violation of several Land Management Ordinances which include regulations for wildlife protection and preservation, preservation of neighborhood character and if Otter Creek is a named waterway, a State-mandated buffer along waters of the State.

Roger Decelles addressed Council, as the President of Hilton Head Big Band, a South Carolina public corporate charity and an all-volunteer ensemble, to let Council know that Hilton Head Big Band raises money by performing concerts and uses those funds to provide instruments and music lessons for underprivileged children and they also raise funds and awareness for veterans and first responders. He asked Council for their support in spreading the word that Hilton Head Big Band has an upcoming concert, opening for a Creedence Clearwater tribute band at the Hilton Beachfront Resort and Spa on October 10th.

Amber Kuehn of Hilton Head Island Sea Turtle Patrol**,** addressed Council to request that Town Council bring up for consideration the plastic bag ban revision in accordance with Beaufort County's request that municipalities work together to figure out a path going forward regarding the revision; additionally, Ms. Kuehn remarked that she has observed that late night activity for kids on the beach appears to occur mainly between beach markers 55 and 70 and has noticed decreased activity this year vs. last year; and she asked Council to please remember the environment along with all the other items Council is working on.

Reports from Members of Town Council

General Reports from Town Council

Ms. Becker thanked the residents from her Ward for coming forward to support the environment and assured them that she would help however she can. Ms. Becker asked Council to consider how they can legally help regarding the issues they heard from the residents in both Palmetto Dunes and Indigo Run. Additionally, Ms. Becker hoped that people would come out to support Hilton Head Big Band and relayed that she attended a meeting at the Hilton Head Island Airport with the Beaufort County Solid Waste and Recycling Advisory Board, which is looking for ways to properly recycle and move trash in a meaningful way.

Ms. Brison reminded everyone that August is National Wellness Month, so please get some exercise, eat well and stay hydrated.

Mayor Perry stated that Council had attended the Municipal Association of South Carolina Conference, and they had the opportunity to discuss the Town's issues with elected officials from other towns and cities in South Carolina that are experiencing similar circumstances, and it was enlightening to see how other municipalities have handled such issues and Mayor Perry expects to keep the lines of communication open with elected officials from other towns and cities to ensure that they all continue to learn from each other.

Mayor Perry also recognized and congratulated the Hilton Head Baseball Association's 12U Ozone All-Stars for winning the 2026 Diamond Youth Baseball Majors World Series.

Report of the Lowcountry Area Transportation Study - Councilmember Tamara Becker

No report.

Report of the Lowcountry Council of Governments - Councilmember Steve Alfred

No report.

Report of the Beaufort County Airports Board - Councilmember Melinda Tunner

Ms. Tunner reported there had not been a meeting but relayed that there have been 128,000 passengers through June at the Hilton Head Island Airport, which includes passengers flying into and out of the airport, up 10.9% as compared to last year.

Report of the Southern Lowcountry Regional Board - Councilmember Patsy Brison

Ms. Brison reported that at the last meeting held in Bluffton, the Board heard reports on Jasper County road construction projects, the I95 project from the Savannah River to Exit 8, the John Smith Road Bridge Replacement project on I95; and a report on Project Phoenix where Hardeeville and Jasper County fire and rescue are considering ways to work together and Ms. Brison recommended that, for a full understanding of the projects and construction, to view the videos of the meetings on the Hardeeville website or Beaufort County channel; she also reported that Jasper County had a sales tax referendum for $470 million and that there was a report shared in connection with the Tri-Share child care program.

Report of the Island Recreation Association Board - Mayor Pro Tempore Alex Brown

Mr. Brown reported that the Hilton Head Island Recreation Center Board will be having its annual planning session on September 25, 2026, and encouraged Council to reach out to him with comments or questions and areas of concern which can be included in the planning for next year, and he mentioned that the Recreation Center has a scholarship program which is often overlooked.

Report of the Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation - Mayor Alan Perry

Mayor Perry reported that Hilton Head Island unfortunately lost a manufacturing business that came in through the Economic Development Corporation and also reported that through a special marketing campaign held in New York and Tampa, there is a family that is looking to bring a life sciences business into the area.

Report of the Gullah Geechee Historic Neighborhoods Community Development Corporation - Mayor ProTempore Alex Brown

Mr. Brown reported that the Gullah Geechee Historic Neighborhoods Community Development Corporation (CDC) will meet on August 19th and will continue its discussion on the Fiscal Year 2027 to 2030 Strategic Plan; they will discuss and consider the Gullah Geechee Historic Neighborhoods Community Development Corporation Small Business Funding Opportunity and enter an Executive Session to receive legal advice related to the CDC's proposed name change.

Report of the Community Development and Public Services Committee - Councilmember Tamara Becker

Ms. Becker reported that the next meeting will be held on September 14, 2026 and items to be

discussed include Consideration of an Ordinance Adopting Amendments to the Land Management Ordinance Related to Natural Resource Protection, Wetland Protection, Tree Protection: Jonesville Road – Residential Single-Family District; Bradley Circle – Residential Single – Family District; and Subdivision and Residential Development Standards.

Report of the Finance and Administrative Committee - Mayor Pro Tempore Alex Brown

Mr. Brown reported that the next meeting is scheduled for September 14, 2026, and the Committee will receive the Town of Hilton Head Island Fiscal Year 2027 Monthly Financial Update and presentations on the Public Safety Service Delivery Assessment Framework and Public Safety Cost Assessment. Mr. Brown encouraged all Town Council members to attend, so everyone may understand the financial side of public safety costs and expectations.

Unfinished Business

Consideration of an Ordinance of the Town of Hilton Head Island, South Carolina, Authorizing the Execution and Delivery of a Sign Easement Encumbering Real Property Owned by the Town of Hilton Head Island, South Carolina - Second Reading - Brittany Ward, Town Attorney

On July 14, 2026, Town Council approved First Reading and there have been no changes since approval.

Mr. Brown moved to approve. Mr. Alfred seconded.

Mayor Perry asked for public comment. There was none.

Motion carried 7-0.

New Business

Consideration of a Resolution of the Town of Hilton Head Island Authorizing the Town Manager to Execute a Financial Participation Agreement with the South Carolina Department of Transportation to Initiate an Engineering Analysis and the Design of Improvements to the Sea Pines Circle - Shawn Gillen, Assistant Town Manager

Sean Gillen, Assistant Town Manager, provided a brief overview.

Mr. Gillen stated that the Financial Participation Agreement outlines the scope, funding and obligations of the Town of Hilton Head Island and the South Carolina Department of Transportation (SCDOT) regarding engineering and design services in advancement of the Sea Pines Circle Project (Project) which consists of improving a traffic circle known as Sea Pines Circle in the Town of Hilton Head Island, South Carolina. The SCDOT will develop engineering analysis and design development for the Project in accordance with SCDOT standards. The Project will be advanced to a 20 to 30% design development level and is to include preliminary design drawings and an engineer's opinion of probable construction cost. Mr. Gillen relayed that no work would commence beyond that point without municipal consent of the Town Council and the work product is estimated to be received in late spring of 2027 for

Town Council consideration.

The Financial Participation Agreement was considered by the Finance and Administrative Committee on July 13, 2026 and the Committee voted unanimously to forward the Agreement to Town Council for consideration.

Mr. Alfred moved to approve. Ms. Becker seconded.

Mayor Perry asked for public comment.

Christopher Cliffe addressed Council to ask them to reconsider spending the funds for this Project, as there have been many proposals for the improvement of Sea Pines Circle performed over the years which were all set aside.

Council held a brief discussion where they received clarification on the scope of the work expected for the $300,000 allocation, which will fund design work up to approximately 30% completion, as well as the expectation that prior design drawings may be used and considered by the engineering firm to be hired by SCDOT. Council members noted that previous design concepts and community feedback, including input from the Sea Pines community, will inform the new design effort, with initial documents anticipated by spring 2027, and that municipal consent will be required before design or construction proceeds and there may a necessity for a separate agreement with the SCDOT to spell out each step of the process. Council also discussed that Project funding responsibilities remain undetermined at this point, and SCDOT, the Town, or a combination may ultimately finance the improvements and acknowledged the existence of traffic challenges, past design objections, and limited options for major changes to the circle. Council confirmed that public input will be incorporated once early design materials are available and that the Project remains a priority in ongoing transportation planning and sales tax referendum considerations.

Motion carried 7-0.

Consideration of a Resolution Authorizing the Town Manager to Execute and Deliver an Amended Stormwater Management and Utility Intergovernmental Agreement between the Town of Hilton Head Island and Beaufort County, South Carolina - Shawn Gillen, Assistant Town Manager

Sean Gillen, Assistant Town Manager, provided a summary.

The original Stormwater Management and Utility Intergovernmental Agreement (IGA) was executed in 2001 and established a cooperative partnership between Beaufort County and the Town of Hilton Head Island, to participate in the countywide Stormwater Management Utility (Utility) operated by the County. The 2001 IGA was amended and extended in 2006 and again in 2016. The 2016 IGA expired on June 30, 2026. The 2026 IGA under consideration is substantively the same terms and conditions established in the previous IGAs, specifically, the 2026 IGA is for a 10 year term with the option to be extended and includes a 180-day written notice requirement for termination at the end of any given fiscal year. The 2026 IGA reaffirms

the terms, conditions, and operational framework for the Utility; and reasserts how the Town will collaboratively manage stormwater infrastructure, enhance water quality, and meet state and federal regulatory mandates. The Town maintains full authority to establish its local stormwater service fee rates each year and is responsible for submitting the approved rates to Beaufort County by June 30. The County's administrative fee is a fixed, per-account charge and does not vary based on the fee assessed to individual properties.

The 2026 IGA reestablishes the Beaufort County Stormwater Implementation Committee, which is responsible for reviewing regulatory amendments, recommending administrative budget adjustments, and providing technical guidance on jointly scoped projects shared between the County and the Town. While Town-led initiatives - such as the Stormwater Master Plan - identify and prioritize system-wide capital needs, the Stormwater Implementation Committee provides the formal structure through which the Town and County coordinate the delivery of projects that cross jurisdictional boundaries or offer mutual benefit to both jurisdictions.

The Amended Stormwater Management and Utility Intergovernmental Agreement was considered by the Finance and Administrative Committee on July 13, 2026 and the Committee voted unanimously to forward the Agreement to Town Council for consideration.

Ms. Becker moved to approve. Ms. Brison seconded.

Mayor Perry asked for public comment. There was none.

Council requested clarification as to how the IGA would be affected as a result of the Stormwater Master Plan whereby the Town is considering taking ownership of certain local roads to improve stormwater service and control over repairs, and Mr. Gillen replied that he did not think there would be an impact on such decisions and pointed-out that the IGA outlines through the Beaufort County Stormwater Implementation Committee, how the Town and Beaufort County would jointly handle a project if the location crossed jurisdictional boundaries, or if there would be shared resources, or if it was mutually beneficial, and if the Town took more stormwater infrastructure into its jurisdiction, there would actually be less opportunity for the facilities to cross jurisdictional boundaries.

Motion carried 7-0.

Consideration of a Resolution Authorizing the Town Manager to Enter into an Agreement with the Hilton Head Audubon Society for Services at Jarvis Creek Park - Angie Stone, Assistant Town Manager

Angie Stone, Assistant Town Manager, provided a summary.

Hilton Head Audubon has developed a Wildlife-Friendly Habitat Certification Program that recognizes properties incorporating habitat features such as native vegetation, water sources, and nesting structures for birds and other wildlife. Jarvis Creek Park has been identified as an ideal demonstration site due to its existing natural features, including native vegetation and

water sources. This project seeks to install bird boxes strategically placed within park boundaries to serve native bird species. The project plan and construction of the boxes are to be carried out by an Eagle Scout candidate seeking to obtain Eagle rank. As a signature requirement of the Eagle Scout program, the candidate must plan and complete a service project that benefits the community. Local Eagle Scout candidate, Jacson Rothman, has built and prepared for installation:

- Two (2) Wood Duck boxes
- One (1) Nuthatch box
- Four (4) Bluebird boxes

These structures will be located around Lake Liggett at Jarvis Creek Park. Once installed, ongoing monitoring and maintenance of structures will be the responsibility of Hilton Head Audubon through a maintenance agreement with the Town of Hilton Head Island, including authorization to perform the work on Town property.

Ms. Brison moved to approve. Ms. Becker seconded.

Mayor Perry asked for public comment. There was none.

Motion carried 7-0.

Public Comment - Non Agenda Items

Mayor Perry asked for public comment. There was none.

Adjournment

At 5:00 p.m., Ms. Becker moved to adjourn. Mr. Alfred seconded. Motion carried 7-0.

Kimberly Gammon, Town Clerk

Alan R. Perry, Mayor

The full recording and a transcript of this meeting can be found on the Town's website at www.hiltonheadislandsc.gov